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COM2020 – Team Project

Prototyping

Week 3 Clinic

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Today you will

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- Experience where lo-fi prototyping works and breaks
- Use prototypes to answer users' questions
- Explore, adopt and use one hi-fi prototyping tool

You've prioritised features and written user stories. You think you know what users want.

Today, you will prove (or disprove) that belief using prototypes.

Build a LO-FI Prototype (20 min)

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Scrum Master enforces lo-fi rules

- A3 papers
- Rough sketches
- No colours
- No polish

Question Set A

Your prototype should answer questions about structure, flow, scope like these four

- What screens exist?
- In what order do they appear?
- What choices does the user make?
- What happens if the user does nothing?

Question Set B

Your prototype should answer questions about interactivity, details, layout like these four

- What wording appears?
- Where exactly does this control live?
- What does the user see first?
- What happens immediately after this click?

Task 1

As a team:

- Pick one Must-have user story from your backlog
- Build a prototype that tries to answer all questions (A + B)

Role-Played Evaluation of LO-FI (10 mins)

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Which questions were best answered by lo-fi?

Which questions cannot be clearly answered? Which set do they mostly belong to? A or B?

Now, what kind of user's questions do you think LO-FI prototype is good for?

If a question cannot be answered clearly → lo-fi failed for that question

Now fidelity increases, but only for failed questions.

Steps	Actions
1	Product Owner: ask each of the previous questions one after the other.
2	Development team members: answer the product owner's questions using faithfully the prototype.
3	Scrum Master: Write down how well the prototype provides answers to each question.

Explore Some Prototyping Tools (25 mins)

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As a team discuss known prototyping tools

- From the lecture
- Any teammates who have used a tool before
- From the provided table

For each tool, quickly check

- Website
- Documentation
- Rating and users feedbacks
- Features and pricing options (when applicable)

Agree on

- One tool that your team will use for this project (check next slide)

Here are some tools:

Some Prototyping Tools
MS Power Point
Figma [link here]
Draw.io [link here]
Balsamiq [link here]
MockFlow [link here]
Axure RP [link here]
Moqups [link here]

Quick Reminder On Prototyping

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What Makes a Good Prototyping Tool?

- Allows easy, rapid modification of interface details or functionality
- Allows direct manipulation of components (especially for non-programmers)
- Supports incremental and evolutionary prototyping (reuse where possible)
- Not constrain the designer to default styles or rigid templates
- Is suitable for requirements animation (e.g. illustrating main screens and flows)

Why Are You Prototyping This?

- **Prototype to learn**→ Reduce uncertainty about user behaviour, flow, or feasibility
- **Prototype to communicate**→ Align understanding between the Product Owner, users, and the team
- **Prototype to de-risk**→ Identify problems early before committing sprint time

Escalate to HI-FI (45 mins)

Product Owner

- Identify **the core feature of your product**(the feature without which the product would fail)

Development Team

- Build a hi-fi prototype of
  - the core feature and
  - any necessary dependencies (supporting screens, navigation, states)
- Use the hi-fi tool your team selected

Scrum Master

- Prevent scope creep
- Ensure the prototype **helps the user and the team agree on what will be built**, not for making the idea look pretty.